SANTHOSH KAPALAVAI

GRC, Cybersecurity & Privacy Leader | Advisory, vCISO & Business Growth Enabler

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Accomplished and visionary executive with 10+ years of proven leadership in Governance, Risk, Compliance (GRC), Cybersecurity, and Privacy across international markets. Known for strategically converting complex regulatory environments into competitive advantages by effectively deploying robust frameworks, enhancing security postures, and optimizing compliance operations.

Visionary and commercially astute GRC, Cybersecurity, and Privacy leader with 10+ years of global experience delivering and selling enterprise-scale risk, compliance, and security programs across India, USA, Middle East, and Southeast Asia. Recognized for transforming regulatory complexity into measurable business value, customer trust, and sustainable revenue.

Trusted advisor to boards, CXOs, and investors on cyber risk, ITGC, SOX, AML controls, privacy, and audit readiness, spanning ISO standards, SOC 2, HITRUST, HIPAA, GDPR, India DPDP Act, NIST, and enterprise risk frameworks. Recognized among India's Top 10 Tech Leaders (2025) with a strong footprint in thought leadership, publications, and global speaking engagements.

Proven success in building and scaling GRC and cybersecurity consulting practices, closing complex advisory and managed service deals, enabling sales teams, and serving as vCISO for SaaS, BFSI, healthcare, and technology-driven enterprises. Operates seamlessly at the intersection of delivery excellence, regulatory assurance, and business growth.

RECOGNITIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- Recognized among "Top 10 Tech Leaders in India – 2025" by TradeFlock
- Author of ISACA-published whitepaper on DPDP Act implementation strategies
- Winner – ISACA competition for innovative privacy and compliance insights
- Featured speaker at international cybersecurity, privacy, and GRC forums
- Instrumental in positioning Dexian as a trusted global GRC & cybersecurity advisory partner

CERTIFICATIONS & QUALIFICATIONS

- **Information Security & Audit**: CISA | CISM | Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)
- **GRC & Risk Management**: GRCP | GRCA | CRCMP | CSOE
- **ISO & Standards**: ISO 27001/42001/9001 Lead Auditor
- **IBM AI Engineering**
- **Project & Process Management**: PMP | Scrum Master | ITIL V4 | Six Sigma Green Belt | CSCP | IPMP
- **Privacy Compliance**: GDPR Expert | DPDP Implementation Specialist
- **'Professional Affiliations**: IRCA Registered Lead Auditor | CQI Practitioner

KEY PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Enterprise Certifications & Assurance:** Led global ISO 27001, 27701, 22301, 9001, 20000-1, 27018 and CMMI Level 5 programs across APAC and EMEA, achieving certifications within **5–8 months** and reducing audit preparation effort by **40%**.
- **Healthcare & Privacy Compliance:** Delivered **HITRUST CSF and HIPAA** alignment programs for healthcare and SaaS clients, strengthening PHI protection, audit readiness, and customer trust.
- **SOC 2, SOX & ITGC Leadership:** Directed SOC 2 Type II, SOX, and ITGC programs for global SaaS and enterprise

clients, strengthening access controls, change management, financial reporting integrity, and audit outcomes.

- **Privacy & Data Protection Excellence:** Led GDPR and DPDP compliance initiatives, standardizing DPIA and RoPA practices and reducing privacy incidents by **70%**.
- **Cyber Risk Reduction:** Designed and implemented enterprise cybersecurity and risk management frameworks aligned with NIST and ISO, reducing security incidents by **55%**.
- **AML & Financial Controls Enablement:** Supported AML control design and governance integration as part of broader risk and compliance programs for regulated and fintech-aligned clients.
- **Vendor & Third-Party Risk:** Transformed vendor risk management frameworks, reducing third-party exposure by **60%** across multinational ecosystems.
- **Business Growth & Revenue:** Directly enabled **multi-million-dollar GRC and cybersecurity advisory pipelines** through solution design, executive presentations, proposal ownership, and long-term client engagement models.

➢ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Senior Manager – Governance, Risk and Compliance**
  Dexian Pvt. Ltd -Chennai/McLean- Sep 2023 – ongoing

  – **Built and scaled global GRC & cybersecurity advisory services**, contributing directly to revenue growth, deal closures, and strategic account expansion across India, Middle East, and Southeast Asia.
  – Led internal and client-facing programs across **ISO 27001, 27701, 22301, 9001, 20000-1, SOC 2, SOX, ITGC, HITRUST, HIPAA, GDPR, DPDP, and NIST** frameworks.
  – Actively supported **pre-sales, proposal development, solution architecture, pricing strategy, and executive-level client presentations**, converting compliance and cyber risk requirements into scalable service offerings.
  – Delivered **SOC 2 Type II readiness and continuous compliance** for SaaS and cloud clients using automated evidence management platforms (Drata, Sprinto, Thoropass).
  – Conducted end-to-end privacy programs including data discovery, data flow mapping, DPIAs, RoPA, consent governance, privacy notices, and cross-border data transfer assessments.
  – Served as **vCISO** for multiple mid-market and enterprise clients, designing governance models, cyber risk roadmaps, ITGC structures, and board-level reporting.
  – Designed enterprise risk registers, Statements of Applicability (SoA), policy suites, control catalogs, and audit roadmaps aligned with business and regulatory priorities.

- **Risk and Compliance Lead**
  Accenture Solutions Pvt. Ltd – Chennai/Canada | Jul 2018 – Sep 2023

  – Directed cross-functional audit teams to execute 1st and 2nd party audits, supply chain audits, and ITGC validations.
  – Integrated regulatory clauses in contracts and engaged legal/procurement on third-party risk mitigation.
  – Enhanced audit frameworks with walkthroughs, evidence matrices, and continuous improvement metrics.
  – Conducted SOX-related walkthroughs and supported external compliance attestations.

- **Senior Representative (Client Quality)**
  SRK Aviacom (Indian Airforce Project) – Hyderabad/Switzerland | Feb 2017 – Jul 2018

  – Interfaced with Airforce stakeholders to align aircraft maintenance and documentation to safety and airworthiness norms.
  – Led internal audits, client walkthroughs, and incident investigations to ensure regulatory alignment.

- **Quality Maintenance Engineer**
  Vision Group of Aviation – Phnom Penh, Cambodia | Feb 2016 – Jan 2017

- **Trainee Engineer**
  Airworks Pvt. Ltd – Mumbai | Jul 2015 – Jan 2016

➢ CORE EXPERTISE

- Governance, Risk & Compliance (GRC)
- Cybersecurity Strategy & Advisory
- ISO 27001 / 27701 / 22301 / 20000-1 / 42001
- SOC 2 Type II | SOC 3 | SOX | ITGC | AML
- HITRUST CSF | HIPAA
- GDPR | DPDP Act
- Enterprise Risk Management
- vCISO Services
- Audit & Assurance | Vendor Risk
- Pre-Sales | Proposal Development | Revenue Enablement
- Tools: Drata, Archer GRC, Thoropass, Sprinto, Zoho, Hyperproof

➢ EDUCATION

- **PGDM (Supply Chain)** – Prin. L. N. Welingkar Institute of Management, 2018–2020
- **Bachelors in Aircraft Engines & Power Plant –** National Aerospace University, KHAI, Ukraine

➢ STRENGTHS & LEADERSHIP TRAITS

- **Strategic Mindset**: Align GRC with business outcomes
- **Global Exposure**: Projects delivered across India, USA, SEA, Gulf
- **CISO Track Readiness**: End-to-end implementation leader
- **Executive Communication**: Frequent client and board-level interfacing
- **Problem Solver**: Combine frameworks, tools, and industry insights for tailored solutions
- **Mentorship**: Guide interns and consultants in audit, compliance, and GRC career tracks

➢ DECLARATION

I hereby declare that all the information provided above is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge. I bear the responsibility for any discrepancies found in the future.

Place: Chennai
Signature: *Santhosh Kapalavai*